

Hollr — a group audio app for friends who already know each other

The Problem

Group chats are exhausting. A thread of four hundred messages between six friends contains perhaps nine that matter, and reading it is a chore that most people do at 11pm with a sense of obligation.

Voice is faster to produce and richer to receive, but voice notes in a chat thread are worse than text: you cannot skim them, you cannot search them, and you have to listen in order.

Our Solution

Hollr is a group audio space for a fixed set of friends.

Each group has a persistent room. People drop in and out through the day, leave audio that stacks into a timeline, and the app transcribes everything so the timeline is skimmable and searchable. You can read what you missed in twenty seconds or listen to it while walking.

Rooms are capped at twelve people. There is no discovery, no following, no public content, and no way to join a room you were not invited to. That is a product decision and it is the reason the app feels the way it does.

The Market

Messaging is used by essentially everyone with a phone. The segment we care about — small closed friend groups who communicate daily — is where the most frequent and most durable usage in consumer social has always been.

Consumer social applications that reach this kind of daily habit have historically been extremely valuable. We are not going to put a number on a market we would have to invent.

Competition

Every messaging app supports voice notes badly. Two audio-social apps have launched in the last three years, both built around public rooms and discovery, and both have declined sharply since launch.

Our bet is the opposite one: closed groups, no discovery, no audience.

The Team

Noor Haddad was a product designer at two consumer companies. Tobias Lang was an iOS engineer and built a note-taking app with several hundred thousand users before joining.

Seven people.

Traction

The engagement is the reason we are raising.

- 140,000 monthly active users
- 61% of registered users are active weekly
- 38 minutes average daily time in app among weekly actives
- 4.1 sessions a day

- 44% of week-one users are still active at week twelve
- 71% of new users arrive through an invitation from an existing group

Twelve-week retention at 44% is roughly four times what consumer social apps typically hold, and it has been stable across six monthly cohorts. Groups that reach four active members almost never go quiet.

We have not spent anything on acquisition. Growth is entirely invitation-driven, which is what you would expect from a product whose only entry point is being invited by a friend.

Go-To-Market

There is nothing to describe here. The app grows by invitation and we have not tried to change that.

Funding

We are raising \$5M to grow the team from seven to eighteen and to keep building for the next eighteen months.